

Keeping warm

Skin plays an important role in keeping the body temperature balanced at 98.6°F (37°C), no matter how hot or cold it is outside. This is the ideal temperature for the body's cells to work at their most efficient.

Losing heat

Body cells produce heat as part of their everyday activities. This heat is lost from the body mainly through the skin. A thermal image, or thermogram, shows how the rate of heat loss differs for different body parts. The warmest parts of the image are light yellow, while the coldest are black.



Our body temperature drops slightly at night, by about 1°F (0.5°C), and rises slightly by day.

**Thermal image
of a boy eating
an ice pop**

